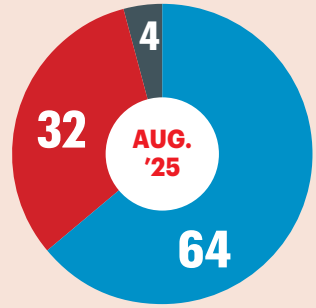
believe that it was an outcome of the pressure from the US president. Only 25 per cent believe it followed Pakistan's request to India after it was hit hard by Indian missile attacks. Almost a third say Modi decided to end the war on his own. Many BJP supporters felt let down by the Modi government declaring a ceasefire after all the hype about decisively defeating Pakistan.

Nor has Operation Sindoor dislodged rebuilding the Ram temple in Ayodhya in the list of the NDA government's top achievements; the temple maintains a five percentage point lead over Operation Sindoor. These are followed by infrastructure development, revocation of Article 370 in Jammu and Kashmir, welfare schemes and a corruption-free government. Among the government's failures, unemployment heads the list, with a high 27 per cent flagging it as a top concern, followed by price rice (21 per cent) and economic growth (7 per cent). Together, they illustrate the growing unease of the electorate on the NDA government's economic stewardship. While 48 per cent feel the central government has done a 'good' to 'outstanding' job of handling the economy, almost an equal number rate the government's performance on this score as either 'average' or 'poor'.

A Looming Economic Storm

There are other trends to indicate that support for the prime minister and the BJP now comes attached with plenty of concerns, conditions and caveats. As many as 72 per cent perceive the unemployment situation in the country to be either 'very serious' (51 per cent) or 'serious' (21 per cent). Only a third believe that the economy will improve in the next six months, with 55 per cent saying it will either stagnate or worsen. Regarding the state of their own daily existence, 61 per cent of respondents believe their current expenses have become difficult to manage. That pessimism comes across in another finding, where 55 per cent believe their household income or salary will either see a reduction or stay

Q. Do you think elections in India are free and fair?



Two-thirds of respondents feel the polls are free and fair; a third beg to disagree



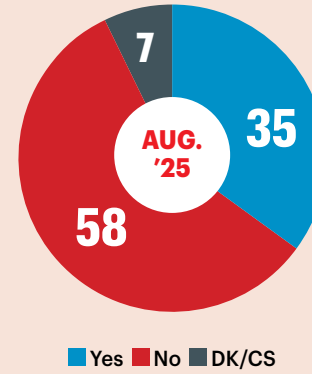
ROLL REVISION A surveyor collects forms from voters during the Special Intensive Revision in Bihar's Bhojpur district, Jul. 5

Q. What's your view on Election Commission conducting SIR in Bihar and its plan to do the same in other states?



70% of respondents think the Bihar roll revision will ensure that only citizens can vote

Q. Do you believe the Opposition's allegation that the BJP manipulated voter rolls to win in Maharashtra and Haryana?



A clear majority disagrees with the charge of voter roll manipulation

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say